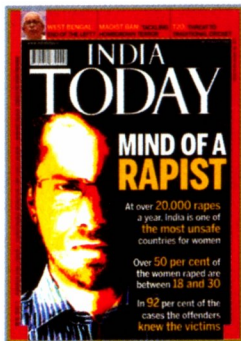


# Mind of a Rapist

JULY 6, 2009

The hot shot film star. The boy next door. Even your lover. If he has a deep-rooted prejudice against women, a history of sexual assaults and a difficult childhood, new research shows that he may well have the makings of a rapist.



“Candid parental interaction is essential for children as it paves way for exchange of views on all aspects of social behaviour, particularly sex crimes by friendly neighbours or close relatives.”

S. LAKSHMI, via [www.indiatoday.in](http://www.indiatoday.in)

## Home Truths

The revelation that “India is one of the most unsafe countries for women” is an overwhelming astonishment (“Mind of a Rapist”, July 6). Women should not anticipate an overnight systemic change. That is why with all emancipation and rights, one should draw a line discriminately defining the limit to act, react and behave as an integral part of the strategy of self-defence. Moreover, since it is a law and order issue, the Government must amend the existing laws with harsh punishment.

INDU SHANKAR, Varanasi

INDIA TODAY has done well to run a cover story on rape. The victims suffer humiliation at every stage—from the crime being reported and inves-



## Miles to Go

Leadership needs vision and mission coupled with maturity and integrity rooted in dedication, passion and patriotism (“The Rahul Revolution”, July 6). These qualities can be ascertained only when a person starts his political journey from ground level. Congress General Secretary Rahul Gandhi, a sudden flyer, does not know this but will soon learn it.

P. ALWARAPPAN, via [www.indiatoday.in](http://www.indiatoday.in)

Rahul Gandhi’s mission to revive the Congress to its old glory by introducing young leaders can surely be successful. But for that to happen, he should choose conscientious and committed people and discard the tainted ones. His right decision will go a long way in making his search a fruitful one.

V.K. TANGRI, Dehradun

tigated to the trial proceedings. To add to the humiliation, only in few cases are the guilty punished. This process has to change. Women, on their part, need to act boldly in such situations.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM,  
Thiruvananthapuram

## Wake-up Call

Regaining control over Lalgarh is important (“Hammered and Stricken”, July 6). A clear message needs to be sent out to the Maoists that they cannot take over territory in any state and declare it as their ‘liberated zone’. If the Left Front Government is incapable of taking decisive action, which it clearly is, the Union Government must not hesitate to step in. Though maintaining law and order is the state

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